Revenge of the Outcast – A Collection

By Solomon Walker, Eric Robert Nolan and Lamar Jorden

INTRODUCTION

* *It's hard to empathize with someone who carries out a school shooting. The brutality is unspeakable, traumatizing to students and communities. But what is it like to be one of these school shooters?*

Studies have shown that most school shooters lead particularly stressful lives: They live with physical or emotional abuse and unstable families. Most have experienced significant losses. Couple these personal traumas with social rejection at school, and you have students with anxiety, depression, aggression and antisocial behavior.

When someone has been struggling alone and failing, their despair can turn into anger. There's loss. There's humiliation. There's anger. There's blame. They may wish someone would kill them. They may wish they could kill themselves. Or they may start fantasizing about revenge.

Revenge of the Outcast – A Collection with poems by Solomon Walker, school shooter by Eric Robert Nolan and Shooter by Lamar Jorden

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Revenge of the Outcast

In a world where darkness reigns supreme,
Where outcasts dwell, unseen, unheard,
A tale of revenge, a daring dream,
Unfolds in verses, untamed, uncurled.

Once an outcast, shunned by the crowd,
A soul forgotten, left to decay,
But within his heart, a fire avowed,
To rise above, to make them pay.

With every step, he embraced the night,
A cloak of shadows, his armour true,
His eyes ablaze, burning with spite,
He vowed to seek vengeance, to pursue.

Through treacherous forests, he did tread,
Where whispers of danger echoed loud,
His heart pounding, filled with dread,
Yet fuelled by a purpose, strong and proud.

He ventured into the dragon's lair,
Where flames danced, fierce and wild,

With sword in hand, he faced despair,
Defying fate, like an innocent child.

The dragon roared, its fury unleashed,
But the outcast fought with all his might,
His blade clashed against scales, unceased,
A battle of darkness, a clash of light.

With a final strike, the dragon fell,
Its reign of terror, forever ceased,
The outcast stood tall, triumphant, compelled,
His victory, a testament to the beast.

But revenge was not yet fully claimed,
For the outcast had a score to settle,
He journeyed on, his heart untamed,
To face the ones who caused his mettle.

Through stormy seas, he sailed with might,
To the kingdom where his tormentors dwelled,
His eyes gleamed with a vengeful light,
As the waves crashed, his fury swelled.

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He stormed the castle, walls crumbling down,
His presence, a tempest, fierce and grand,
His enemies trembled, their faces a frown,
As he took their fate into his own hand.

With each strike, he reclaimed his pride,
His tormentors fell, one by one,
Their cries for mercy, swiftly denied,
As the outcast's revenge was finally done.

In the aftermath, he stood alone,
A victor, yet still an outcast, true,
But in his heart, a newfound tone,
A sense of purpose, a life anew.
For revenge had shaped him, made him strong,
And though he remained an outcast, scorned,
He had proven them all, proved them wrong,
That even the forgotten can be reborn.

So let this tale be a testament,
To the power of vengeance, fierce and bold,
That even the outcasts, long lamented,
Can rise above, their stories untold.

For in the depths of darkness, they find,

A strength untamed, a spirit unbound,

And in their hearts, a fire designed,

To conquer the world, to astound.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Solomon Walke
On-line Transcript:
https://medium.com/@creativehubs2/revenge-of-the-outcast-a-poem-80ee1b52d50e
Publisher: Medium.com
Date (Month/Year): July 26, 2023

school shooter (excerpt)

Grendel's mother wanted murder; but we all knew that,

you knew that just by looking at her:

the green and odorous skin like dark olive parchment over

her cheeks' low bones,

the blackening teeth where the stale blood caked

and dried in her receding gumlines

like burgundy ink on her molars and incisors,

and a blackening-scarlet

stain on her canines.

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Remember her mocking our own mothers?

Her derisive voice was like

the crack of splitting emeralds, asking,

"Am I so strange to young eyes?"

Remember the boiling fat on her tongue and

her victims' burning skin there?

The scalps she held in her upturned palms

were like watery garments.

Her talons were as black

as snapping-turtle shells.

We all knew at once that we were quarry.

Remember her

sorrel-colored cataracts?

Her eyes were as green seas

boiling under Ragnarok.

Remember their ruptured capillaries

like collapsing red galaxies?

Remember her very irises bleeding?

But what if evil appeared
not as the face of Grendel's mother,
but, rather, the ordinary boy in her maw —
as unexotic and as common
as we are?

If we were boys and girls again
and bored in English class —
maybe at Beowulf's strangeness —
and he were next to us,
with neither green skin
nor blood along his molars,
if he wanted murder, could we tell?

His face was as a clock's face — prosaic and round.
Neither silt nor sinew lined his frame.
His gaze did not depict a grisly cosmos;
no galaxies had hemorrhaged in his eyes.
Would the difference be perceptible there
between wanting to kill time
and wanting to kill ten?
Would we know that we were quarry?

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SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Eric Robert Nolan
Book: Peeking Cat Anthology 2018, Pgs 59-61
ISBN: 978-0244422905
Publisher: Lulu.com
Date (Month/Year): Oct 2018

Shooter (excerpt)

2:36 pm
Bullets bask in barrel before booming.
Students zooming towards exit run rampant
like thoughts in my head.
Any student not thought to be dead
gets shot again
Students think "not again" . . .
Students scream aloud as rounds rip through the crowd.
The scene is wild
but for once,
I get to be center stage.
Behind my blank look I'm in a rage,
a renegade,
tamed, but in a cage I stand
stance stiff as a statue starin' at you.
Shots and shotgun shells fly like pterodactyls.

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The scene is so thick,
which fits cuz I'm an outcast.
But this is no "Player's Ball."
This is a scene of prayers, calls and screams.
Anybody from teens to professors to football players crawl,
and I spray ‘em all.
Lay ‘em all down in a timely fashion.
As they're dashin' to safety, I'm safely solid as a mannequin
Brandishin' three handguns and a shotgun
The world is goin’ crazy,
The world is goin’ crazy, I'm just a daily reminder.
Scrutinize my autopsy, you still won't find a spine to justify
my acts.
You run from my bullets but can't escape the fact that this
goes back.
This goes back to the 19th century in elementaries around
the globe.
1891
St. Mary's Parochial School.
Fools before me used shotguns to empty a class.
Fast forward 36 years.
1927

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2nd to 6th graders were the targets,
45 were martyred,
58 more wounded at the hands of school board member
Andrew Kehoe.
Y'all upset at me though.
This coward killed kids because his farm was being
foreclosed.

I swear the world is goin' crazy.
The world is insane.

Gunsmoke and sudden death make the atmosphere putrid.
Today's Valentine's Day homie, I wanna be Cupid.
Slugs replace arrows,
Icebox replaces heart that I can't seem to find.
No one seems to mind that students show more school
spirit when
someone is dead.

Shots to the head seemingly make you more popular -
that has to be why most the shooters kill themselves
My blood boils at the realization that you can get killed for
nothin’ in college

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just as easily as you can in a war or in jail,

but we're still more concerned with weed sales . . .

The world is beyond crazy.

Why are we overseas when the real war is in front of us?

The real war is in the institutions that are supposed to build

a better tomorrow.

The sorrow is in the hearts of those who fall victim to those

dimming bright futures.

Because guns don't kill people,

we kill ourselves

I'm sorry. I'm sorry. . . I'm sorry. . .

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Lamar Jorden
Documentary: Louder than a Bomb, Film Curriculum, Pg 37
https://www.louderthanabombfilm.com/docs/LTAB-Film-Curriculum.pdf
ISBN: Documentary DVD
Publisher: Siskel/Jacobs Productions
Date (Month/Year): Mar 2012

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Material used in the introduction can be found here: https://www.npr.org/sections/health-shots/2019/02/10/690372199/school-shooters-whats-their-path-to-violence

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